Experiment - 16

Clone a Virtual Machine and Test the Cloned VM

Aim

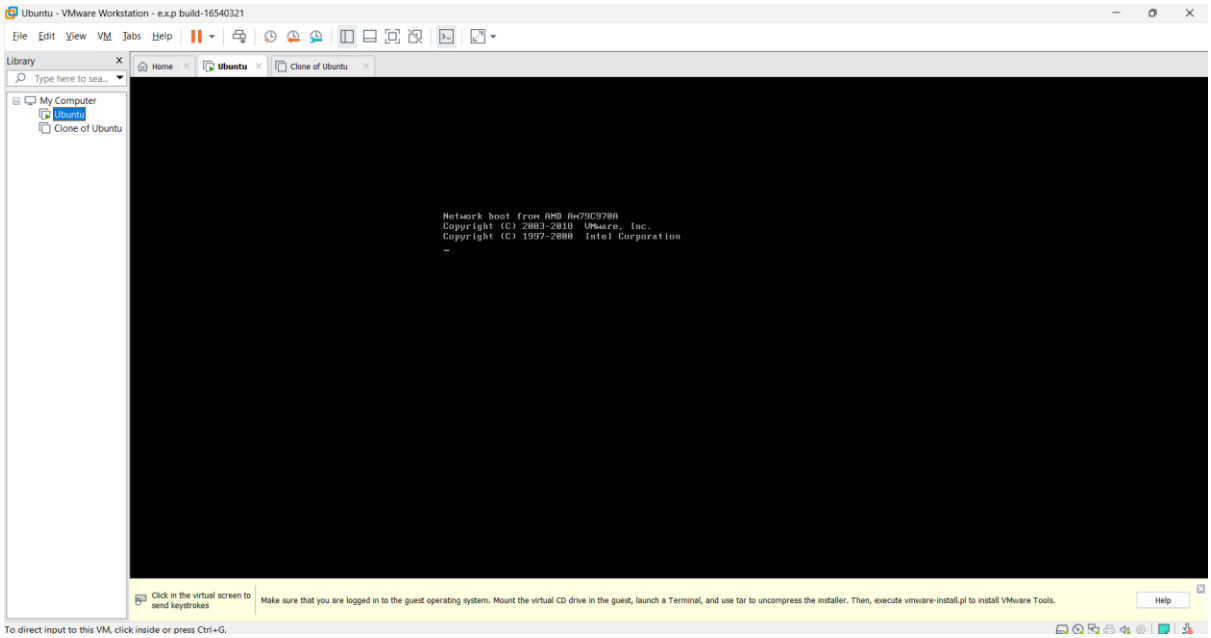
To create a clone of an existing virtual machine using virtualization software and verify that the cloned virtual machine can run independently.

Procedure

1. Start the computer and open Oracle VirtualBox or VMware Workstation.
2. Select an existing virtual machine that has an installed operating system.
3. Shut down the virtual machine before cloning, if required.
4. Open the cloning option in the virtualization software.
5. VirtualBox: Right-click the VM and select Clone.
6. VMware Workstation: Use the Manage → Clone option, if available in your edition.
7. Enter a name for the cloned virtual machine, such as Ubuntu-VM-Clone.
8. Select the clone type:
9. Full Clone: Creates an independent copy of the virtual machine.
10. Linked Clone: Uses the original VM's virtual disk as a base and requires it to remain available.
11. Choose the appropriate snapshot state or current machine state, depending on the available options.
12. Start the cloning process and wait for it to complete.
13. Verify that the cloned virtual machine appears in the VM list.
14. Start the cloned virtual machine.
15. Check that the guest operating system boots successfully.
16. Create a test file or make a small configuration change in the cloned VM.
17. Verify that the cloned VM works independently. For a full clone, check that changes do not affect the original VM.
18. Shut down the cloned virtual machine after testing.

Implementation

Output:



Result

Thus, a snapshot of a virtual machine was successfully created and restored, demonstrating how snapshots can preserve and recover a virtual machine's previous state.